Leave, Travel and Expense Policy - Brightline Design Studio

SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT written for evaluating Margin. The company and all details are fictional.

Policy owner: People Operations. Version 4.2, effective 1 April 2026. Applies to all full-time employees in India. Contractors and interns are covered only where stated.

1. Annual Leave

Full-time employees earn 22 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued at 1.83 days per month. Employees may carry forward up to 10 unused days into the next year; any days above that lapse on 31 March. Leave of five or more consecutive working days must be requested at least three weeks in advance through the HR portal. Managers must respond to a leave request within 3 working days.

2. Sick Leave

Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per year, which cannot be carried forward. A medical certificate is required for sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days. Interns receive 6 days of paid sick leave for a six-month internship.

3. Parental Leave

Birthing parents receive 26 weeks of fully paid leave. Non-birthing parents receive 6 weeks of fully paid leave, which can be taken in up to three blocks within the first 12 months after the birth or adoption. Adoptive parents of a child under three months old receive the same leave as birthing parents. Employees returning from parental leave may work a reduced schedule of four days per week at full pay for their first eight weeks back.

4. Public Holidays

The studio observes 12 public holidays per year, published each December for the following year. Employees may swap up to 2 of these for other religious or cultural festivals by telling their manager at least two weeks before.

5. Travel

All business travel must be approved by the employee's manager before booking. Flights are booked in economy class for trips under 6 hours; premium economy is allowed for longer flights. Bookings should be made at least 14 days in advance where possible. Hotels are reimbursed up to INR 9,000 per night in metro cities (Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata) and INR 6,000 per night elsewhere.

6. Daily Allowance and Meals

Employees travelling overnight receive a daily allowance of INR 2,500 for meals and local transport, with no receipts required. For day trips, actual meal costs are reimbursed up to INR 1,200 with receipts. Alcohol is never reimbursed.

7. Submitting Expenses

Expenses must be submitted in the expense tool within 30 days of being incurred, with itemised receipts for any single item above INR 500. Claims submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed unless the Finance Director grants an exception in writing. Approved claims are paid with the next monthly payroll. Corporate cards may be used only for approved business expenses; personal use, even if repaid, may lead to the card being withdrawn.

8. Equipment and Home Office

New employees receive a laptop and a one-time home-office allowance of INR 25,000 for a desk, chair or monitor, claimable within their first 90 days. Equipment remains studio property and must be returned within 7 days of an employee's last working day.

9. Exceptions and Questions

Any exception to this policy needs written approval from the employee's manager and the Head of People Operations. Questions about this policy go to people@brightline.example. Breaches of this policy may result in disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct.